Project status and near-term plan

Canonical name: `03_Where_we_are_now.md`
Original archive: `obsolete/original_filenames/PROJECT_STATUS_AND_NEAR_TERM_PLAN.md`

> ***Maintained by: COMPASS*** *(cross-project planner). See COMPASS_AGENT_IDENTITY.md.*

Date: 2026-06-24 (Phase A execution complete)
Author: COMPASS
Print stack: `Charles_reading_list.md` — symbol decoder: `01_forward_plan_reading_guide.md` **Symbol systems**
Companion docs (active numbered):
- 02_Charles_decisions_locked.md — **Tier 1 locks filed**
- 08_Basketball_figures_on_disk.md — D10 bundle
- 09_Tenure_export_on_disk.md — inference export
- 10_Manuscript_ink_map.md — Word routing
- 12_Manuscript_staging_prose.md — copy-from prose
- 14_PD12_reassessment_memo.md — PD12 ladder (reference)
- Pre–Tier 1 correspondence → `obsolete/`

Executive summary

The dissertation program is a **three-setting cross-domain study** of **advancement under constrained distinction**, with Army as anchor, basketball as replication, and academia as preliminary third leg.
Convergence (now): The scientific bottleneck has shifted from discovery to **convergence**:

	Task
a.	Empirical inverted-U patterns are **established** (Army, basketball) and **preliminary** (tenure).
b.	Close the **minimal generative model** (honest claims).
c.	Export **model-guided empirical features** (PD12 Priority 3 — quality vs congestion).
d.	Lock **2–3 testable predictions**.
	Draft a **Wang-style manuscript**.

Next: These were deferred; review next unless they should move into the current draft:

	Item	Plain English
a.	**525/UIC deep dives**	Prestige-organization / senior-rater consistency work — test whether “prestigious unit” effects hold up empirically in Army data. *(Charles: PDE issue — revisit when manuscript needs more Army mechanism meat.)*
b.	**Network-science extensions**	Talent center-of-gravity (individual + unit), talent paradox, exposure/comparison networks — strong candidates for later manuscript §8 or dissertation chapters.
c.	**3-domain parametric identifiability** (PD12 P1)	Estimate separate $B(Q)$ and $D(Q)$ legs with identifiable parameters across all three settings — beyond v1 minimal model.
d.	**Fourth-domain falsification** (PD12 P4)	Add a fourth empirical setting to stress-test generality.
e.	**Generative LOO-pool-quality bin-for-bin matching**	Make the basketball generative simulation reproduce the empirical `poolq_loo` curve point-for-point — north-star parallel work, not v1 blocker (Path II).

Elevate any row only if **Charles or Alex** says so; otherwise Part VII opportunity-cost rule applies.
Phase A (2026-06-24): Tier 1 locks filed; SCOUT D10 bundle on disk; PEER `faculty_panel_inference_v1.csv` exported (796 persons / 52 depts); staging prose written (`12_Manuscript_staging_prose.md`). **Next:** ink **`Manuscript_working_outline_v1.docx`** using `10_Manuscript_ink_map.md` (**manuscript §5 → §1 → §4**, then **§0** opening frame — see `#01` symbol decoder); Army AWS sync + Alex Tier 3; Layer B Cox pre-submission.
PD12 alignment (2026-06-15): v1 delivers Priority 3 + partial Priority 2 (talent-only fail). P1 and P4 deferred explicitly — not silent drift. See reassessment memo.
Target: core manuscript draft/submission **Summer–Fall 2026** (~3–6 months).

Charles clarifications (COMPASS thread, 2026-06-11)

#	Topic	Decision
1	Hard deadline	**Summer–Fall 2026** for core manuscript draft/submission
2	Tenure Cox gate	**Soft gate (B):** stage 9 + honest limitations OK for VECTOR to draft Setting 3; **one basic Cell 12 Cox run in parallel** before submission (not a pre-draft blocker); Fine–Gray deferred
3	SCOUT generative priority	**A — manuscript-first (Path II):** draft with honest layering; generative LOO-pool-quality match **deferred**; Alex score = constraint-leg POC on **pool mean** axis; empirical decomposition for predictions; explicit nesting required in prose
4	Tenure Cell 12 urgency	**Charles confirmed (2026-06-11):** no hurry on planned Cell 12 in `540_tenure_pipeline.ipynb` during **draft phase**. Current **CELL 9** binned plot (`stage9_inverted_u.png`) is **legitimate preliminary descriptive evidence** for process trust and VECTOR Setting 3 prose (with limitations). **Basic Cox** remains pre-**submission** parallel work (PEER-owned); **Fine–Gray** may return before publication if estimand requires it — not gating draft
—	Scientific north star	Unified decomposable generative on LOO axis — **parallel**, does not gate first draft
—	Terminology lock	Any quantity **excluding self** must include `LOO` in the name (`poolq_loo` = LOO pool quality; `team_mean` / pool mean = whole roster, not LOO)
—	Model coherence	`20260611_1626_COMPASS_to_SCOUT_model_coherence_questions.md` **revised** for locked Path II — SCOUT must supply nesting chain + deliverables D1–D11, not path choice
—	Alex comms	Plan update briefs — Charles's sequencing calls; optional perspective welcome, not a decision questionnaire

Part I — Foundational context

Pivotal insights (nuggets): `13_INSIGHT_NUGGETS.md` — cross-project framing worth keeping while reading this doc and the forward plan.

Foundational project summary (dissertation origins)

Original vision (Aug 2024 proposal): *Deciphering the Talent Mosaic* — use Army PDE/OER data and network methods (Officer Career Network, Officer Professional Network) to quantify **unit prestige**, **peer effects**, and **rater evaluation tradeoffs** across three Army chapters (Q1–Q3). Methods: eigenvector centrality, survival analysis, West Point Post Night validation.

What persisted: Army closed labor market; OER/senior-rater pools; competing promotion/attrition; Evans stack-ranking misclassification; Barabási/Gates science-of-science framing; talent management policy relevance.

What morphed: Prestige-centrality chapters → **LOO peer-pool quality inverted-U** as cross-domain stylized fact; **basketball + tenure** added; theory reframed as **finite distinction in local comparison environments**; generative Tier 1 modeling on basketball.

Original hypotheses (evolved): Prestigious units/peers help until they hurt (H2/H3 spirit) → now explicit **inverted-U** with mechanism decomposition path.

Expected contributions (current framing):
1. Replicated empirical regularity across military, sport, academia.
2. Minimal mechanism (congestion-adjusted advancement score + pool formation).
3. Non-obvious predictions distinguishing competing explanations.
4. Foundation for network-science extensions (deferred).

Committee expectations: Barabási — universality, minimal models, high impact; Gates — day-to-day direction, generative discipline, Wang ladder; **Dakota Murray** — tenure setting expertise (v03 brief sent); Vespignani — complex systems audience.

Advisor guidance summary

Primary advisor (operations): Alex Gates — prioritization, manuscript sequencing, generative mechanism.
Strategic advisor: Laszlo Barabási — framing, replication, network extensions (future).

Recurring themes (Alex, from memos + agent reports)

Theme	Source	Implication
Theory ≠ minimal model	`2026_0430_Paper7_feedback.md`	Rich theory; sparse formal model
Quadratic is diagnostic, not mechanism	`2026_0507_Alex_Gates_Post_Meeting_Simulation_Memo.md`	Keep in `sports/538_alex_tier1_model_and_fit.ipynb` empirical work; generative story is sorting + comparison
Assortative pools + local comparison	PD10–PD12, `Alex_model_interpreted.md`	PD11 threads A/B/C ordering
End-to-end measurement before perfection	PEER Apr 2026 advisor direction	Stage 9 before infinite scrape
Cross-domain minimal story	PD11, Alex Tier 1 spine	Don't calibrate generative on observed team means only
Parallel tracks: code + publication	`advisor_brief_twofold_status.md`	But **manuscript now beats 525** for near-term

Alex priorities (PD12 + inferred)

Priority	PD12 name	v1 status
P3	Model-guided empirical features (congestion vs quality)	**In scope** — SCOUT D10 export + staging `#12` **§3** (Methods)
P2	Extreme events / kill switches	**Partial** — talent-only fail; full 539 sweeps deferred
P1	Parameter identifiability (3-domain fit)	**Deferred** — post-v1 / dissertation
P4	Falsification / 4th domain	**Deferred** — post-v1

Alex concerns

- Over-claiming generative replication on L_Q.
- Presenting quadratic as theory.
- Fine–Gray / estimand sloppiness.
- Endless data expansion without curves.

Mental model of Alex (planning aid)

Question	Working answer
What problem are we solving?	Nonlinear advancement from **local pool quality × finite distinction**, explained by **minimal generative mechanism**, replicated cross-domain.
What evidence convinces him?	3-panel empirical U; generative ability-only null; congestion score POC; **model-guided features exported**; 1–2 sharp predictions tested or test-ready.
What would he cut?	Network extensions pre-paper; legacy `sports/537_tier1_benchmark.ipynb`; "538D decomposes 539"; causal overclaim.
What would he prioritize?	PD11 thread C→A; Wang ladder empirical; one heterogeneity prediction.
Top risks he watches	Axis/estimand confusion; distraction from writing; tenure overclaim without Cox.

Refine after Charles routes Planner question responses.

Part II — Current state

Cross-project architecture

```
flowchart LR
    subgraph empirical [Empirical]
        CODA[Army_CODA]
        SCOUT[Basketball_SCOUT]
        PEER[Tenure_PEER]
    end
    subgraph theory [Integration]
        VECTOR[VECTOR_manuscript]
    end
    subgraph plan [Planning]
        MP[COMPASS]
    end
    CODA --> VECTOR
    SCOUT --> VECTOR
    PEER --> VECTOR
    CODA --> MP
    SCOUT --> MP
    PEER --> MP
    VECTOR --> MP
```

Domain status

Army (CODA) — Setting 1

Dimension	Status
Pipeline	`520_pipeline_cox_working.ipynb` end-to-end
Inverted-U	**Established** — CIF Q-bins; Cox quadratics + interaction
Competing risks	Cell 11 descriptive CIF; Cell 12 cause-specific Cox
Recent add-ons	TB-stratify CR (`cr_tb_stratify.py` , default off)
Open issues	Pool-size >100 audit; AWS upload; 525/UIC planned not executed
Confidence	**High** for descriptive U; **medium-high** for Cox curvature

Assumptions carrying weight: Last-snapshot bin assignment for CIF plots; LOO pool minus mean as peer quality; CS/CSS cohort filters in run profiles.

Basketball (SCOUT) — Setting 2

Dimension	Status
Panel	`530_sports_pipeline.ipynb` → `datasets/mbb/player_season_panel_530.csv`
Inverted-U	**Replicated** on `poolq_loo`
Empirical ladder	`538_alex_tier1_model_and_fit.ipynb` — bins, LPM, logit, L^*
Generative	`sports/538D_development.ipynb` CELL 10; $S_i = A_i - wL_C$; inverted-U on **team_mean**, not L_Q match
Open issues	L_Q generative gap; CELL 7 robustness in `sports/538_alex_tier1_model_and_fit.ipynb`; near-threshold export parked (now in D10 — `#08`)
Confidence	**High** empirical; **medium** generative (conditional)

Assumptions carrying weight: PPM+z performance; LOO teammate pool; ever-draft outcome.

Academia (PEER) — Setting 3

Dimension	Status
Pipeline	`540_tenure_pipeline.ipynb` Cells 0–9 complete; Layer B (10/10.5/12) **planned**
Inverted-U	**Preliminary** — stage 9, 18 bins, elite bin dip; **Charles: trustworthy for draft** (unconditional bins; see `Pertinent_Thoughts_Tenure.md`)
Cox	Layer B **planned** (port `520` → `540`); Cell 12 **not archived** — **not urgent for draft**; basic run before submission (soft gate)
Fine–Gray	**Deferred** — revisit before publication if needed; not required for first VECTOR pass
Data limits	~58% OA NONE; high censoring; 168 schools variable quality
Confidence	**Low–medium**

Assumptions carrying weight: Wayback tenure events; LOO assistant pub intensity; unresolved ≠ attrition ambiguity.

Modeling status

Scientific progression ladder (PD12-aligned — defs in `#01`)

```
Rung 1  Phenomenon (inverted-U on LOO proxy — triad)
Rung 2  Minimal mechanism (Path II generative POC — basketball)
Rung 2.5  Model-guided empirical features (quality vs congestion — export in D10)
Rung 3  Predictions (near-threshold; Λ)
Rung 4  Manuscript
```

Minimal model (VECTOR / Tier 1)

Equation-level claim:

$$S_i = A_i - \lambda L_{C,i}$$

Architecture: Soft assignment pools (τ≈0.65) → congestion from viable peers → top-K or threshold selection → plot axis matters.

Capability	Status
Empirical U on Q	✅ Army, basketball; preliminary tenure
Ability-only generative null	✅ Confirmed
Congestion score implemented	✅
Model-guided features (quality vs congestion)	✅ in pipeline; **D10 export pending**
Inverted-U generative (team_mean)	✅
Inverted-U generative (L_Q LOO)	❌ Not matched
$B(Q) - D(Q)$ decomposition estimated	❌ Deferred
Evans sim embedded	❌ Theory only

Known weaknesses

1. Generative/empirical **axis mismatch** on basketball.
2. Tenure **inferential layer** missing.
3. **Prediction list** not locked.
4. Mechanism **decomposition** not identified.
5. Army CIF **estimand simplicity** vs prose ambition.

Outstanding modeling questions

- Is LOO-pool-quality generative match required for v1? **No** (Charles Path A) — honest axis table + limitations; parallel north-star work optional
- Which noise bundle (539 vs 538D) is domain-appropriate?
- Does tenure need Fine–Gray or cause-specific Cox suffices?

Predictions

How to read this section: These are **candidate predictions** — directions the model suggests, not finished proofs. v1 manuscript will name **#1** and **#2** as primary; the others are exploratory or deferred. Glossary: `01_forward_plan_reading_guide.md`.

v1 primary slots (manuscript §7 / staging `#12` §4)

#	Name (shorthand)	Plain English — what would count as support?	Status today	Where in repo
#1	Near-threshold heterogeneity	Among players who are **good but not superstars**, the elite-pool dip should be **steepest** — congestion hurts people **near the cut line**, not the very best or the clearly below-average.	**Candidate.** One basketball figure exported; not a formal cross-domain test.	`sports/538D_development.ipynb` **CELL 4D** → `heterogeneity_ventiles_top_tail.png` (listed in `#08`)
#2	Peak shift with Λ (Lambda)	When an organization has **more scarce advancement slots** (bigger boards, more draft picks, more tenure lines), the **top** of the inverted-U should **move** — global capacity matters, not only local peer quality.	**Conceptual only.** Prose hook for Army; no finished Λ-sweep figure.	Army narrative (CODA); defer cross-domain parameter sweep

Do say: "primary prediction **directions**."
Do not say: "predictions are fully validated across all settings" (see `07_Claim_language_guardrails.md` §F).

Other candidate predictions (exploratory / supplement / defer)

Name (shorthand)	Plain English	Status today	Next step
Mean × SD peer dispersion (538D CELL 4B/4C)	The downturn might depend on **how spread out** talent is within a pool (mean quality **and** dispersion), not mean alone.	Exploratory EDA done in notebook	Decide main text vs appendix
Own-TB stratified pool-U (Army)	The inverted-U shape might **differ by your own performance** (own "talent bucket" / TB): same pool quality, different slope for high vs mid performers.	CODA coded; **off** by default	Run if Alex wants for Army meeting
Assortativity required for U	You need **realistic overlapping pools** (soft assignment), not fake disjoint talent bins, for the generative story to work.	Partially shown — talent-only fails; soft assign + congestion bends curves	Already part of generative POC narrative (`537` falsifies sort-and-chop; `538` soft assign)

COMPASS recommendation for v1: Ship with **#1 (near-threshold)** as the main discriminating readout + **#2 (Λ peak-shift)** as honest prose hook — plus one of mean×SD or own-TB stratification **only if** time allows; do not block draft on the exploratory rows.

Manuscript readiness

Section	Support level	Gap
Framing sentence	✅ Dakota v03, briefing outlines	Lock final title
3-panel empirical figure	⚠️ 2.5/3	PEER Cox beneficial pre-submit; not blocking first draft
Theory (local/global, distinction)	✅ Tier1_Narrative, Vector_Master_Theory	VECTOR prose pass
Minimal model	⚠️	Axis honesty paragraph
Generative figures	⚠️	team_mean POC; L_Q caveat
Predictions	❌	List + one test
Limitations	✅ Agent reports	Merge tenure OA gaps
Network extensions	Defer	**Manuscript §8** (Dakota v03)

Publication risks

1. **Over-claiming** generative replication.
2. **Estimand conflation** (CIF vs Cox; Fine–Gray mention).
3. **Tenure thin** at submission without Cox (soft gate allows draft-first).
4. **Scope creep** (525, networks) delaying draft.

Target template: Wang et al. 2019 — cross-domain stylized fact → minimal mechanism → predictions (not literal k-memory copy).

Part III — Success criteria

1. Minimal model complete

Tier	Criterion
Required	Score equation specified; ability-only null documented; congestion generative POC with **explicit axis table**; soft-assignment pool formation described
Beneficial	L_Q generative match improved; L^* reported all three settings
Defer	Full Evans sim; $B(Q) - D(Q)$ separate estimation; HPC sweeps

2. Robust predictions

Tier	Criterion
Required	2 predictions stated; ≥1 testable with existing exports or ≤1 week SCOUT/PEER work
Beneficial	3 predictions; heterogeneity figure in draft
Defer	Network-based predictions; Λ shift cross-domain

3. Publishable manuscript

Tier	Criterion
Required	Full draft all sections; 3 empirical panels; honest limitations; Alex read-ready
Beneficial	Tenure Cox table; generative supplement figure
Defer	Journal submission; network §; 525 Army extensions

Part IV — Recommended near-term sequence

Horizon: Next 6–10 weeks (adjust when Charles provides deadlines).

Phase A — Lock language (Week 1)

Step	Owner	Output
A1	COMPASS + Charles	Initial Review + plan largely locked (2026-06-11); revise on agent answers
A2	Charles → agents	Answers as `YYYYMMDD_HHMM_{AGENT}_to_COMPASS.md` (see each question file § How to respond) — **CODA:** 20260611_1633_CODA_to_COMPASS.md
A3	VECTOR	Claim language table (supported / preliminary / not supported)
A4	All agents	Shared glossary: pool quality, LOO, distinction, inverted-U

Phase B — Close blocking science gaps (Weeks 2–3)

Step	Owner	Output	Priority
B1	PEER	Run Cell 12; archive HR tables	**Low for now** — Charles: no hurry during draft; schedule before **submission** only (soft gate); PEER-owned when routed
B2	CODA	Manuscript figure exports + estimand sentences	**High**
B3	SCOUT	Manuscript empirical exports; generative axis figure for supplement	**High**
B4	SCOUT	LOO-pool-quality generative match	**Deferred** — parallel only (Charles Path A); nesting prose + axis table are blocking

Phase C — Manuscript draft (Weeks 3–6)

Step	Owner	Output
C1	VECTOR	Outline from Dakota v03 + Wang structure
C2	VECTOR	**Manuscript §1–§2** empirical + theory (from staging `#12` §2)
C3	VECTOR	**Manuscript §5** minimal generative model + honest status (staging `#12` §2.3 + §3.2)
C4	VECTOR	**Manuscript §7** predictions (staging `#12` §4; #1 and #2 locked)
C5	Charles + Alex	Advisor read; revise claims

Phase D — Prediction execution (parallel Weeks 4–6)

Step	Owner	Output
D1	SCOUT	Near-threshold heterogeneity export refresh (`sports/538D_development.ipynb` CELL 4D) OR own-TB analog
D2	PEER	One robustness: alternate bins or OA filter
D3	CODA	TB-stratify panels **if** Alex requests

Phase E — Submission prep (Weeks 7–10)

Step	Owner	Output
E1	VECTOR	Full manuscript polish
E2	Charles	Committee circulation
E3	COMPASS	Phase 2 artifacts if desired: DECISION_LOG, OPEN_QUESTIONS

```
gantt
    title NearTermSequence
    dateFormat YYYY-MM-DD
    section Lock
    ReviewApproval           :a1, 2026-06-11, 7d
    AgentQuestions           :a2, 2026-06-11, 14d
    section Science
    PEER_Cox                 :b1, 2026-06-18, 14d
    CODA_Figures             :b2, 2026-06-18, 10d
    SCOUT_Exports            :b3, 2026-06-18, 10d
    section Manuscript
    VECTOR_Draft             :c1, 2026-06-25, 28d
    section Predictions
    HeterogeneityTest        :d1, 2026-07-02, 21d
```

Part V — Explicit deferrals (until core manuscript complete)

Workstream	Agent	Rationale
525 UIC / senior-rater consistency	CODA	Army depth; not required for 3-setting paper
Pool-size >100 audit	CODA	Methods note; disclaimer may suffice v1
Full L_Q generative match	SCOUT	High cost; empirical U already replicated
538 CELL 7+ FE/clustering	SCOUT	Robustness post-draft (`sports/538_alex_tier1_model_and_fit.ipynb`)
HPC parameter sweeps	SCOUT	Exploration
537 legacy sim	SCOUT	Frozen benchmark (`sports/537_tier1_benchmark.ipynb`)
Tenure URL scrape expansion	PEER	Alex: measure on hand first
NRC/USNews prestige merge	PEER	v2
Network science **manuscript §8** extensions	VECTOR	Dakota marks exploratory
OCN eigenvector prestige chapters	CODA/VECTOR	Original dissertation Ch1–3; future dissertation scope
`Publication_Plan.md` §2 mechanism paragraphs	VECTOR/Charles	Fill after draft skeleton
Phase 2 planning files	COMPASS	After this plan approved

Part VI — Agent coordination

Ownership (near-term)

Artifact	Owner
Dakota v03 RTF refresh	VECTOR + Charles
Alex Tier 1 spine	SCOUT maintains; VECTOR cites
Army manuscript figures	CODA
Basketball manuscript figures	SCOUT
Tenure manuscript figures	PEER
Cross-domain prose	VECTOR
This plan + decision log	COMPASS

Dependency graph (critical path)

```
PEER Cell 12 ──▶ VECTOR Setting 3 §
CODA estimand sentences ──▶ VECTOR Methods  *(filed 2026-06-11: [20260611_1633_CODA_to_COMPASS.md](20260611_1633_CODA_to_(
SCOUT axis table ──▶ VECTOR Generative §
Claim language table ──▶ All sections
Charles locked Q1–3 ──▶ Sequence lock (CODA Q4+ open)
```

How to read the arrows: `──▶` means the thing on the **left** must exist (or be decided) before the thing on the **right** can be written properly. This is a **coordination map** for who feeds whom — not a list of things that all block you from starting the draft today.

Chain 1: Tenure survival analysis → Tenure manuscript section

Shorthand: `PEER Cell 12 ──▶ VECTOR Setting 3 §`

Term	Meaning
PEER	Tenure/academia agent — owns `540_tenure_pipeline.ipynb` and the faculty panel export
Cell 12	Planned notebook cell: Cox proportional hazards on tenure data (Layer B, ported from Army `520`); produces hazard-ratio tables beyond the descriptive binned plot
VECTOR	Manuscript-writing agent (Scholar GPT) — turns staging prose into Word-ready text
Setting 3 §	Third empirical setting (academia/tenure). Word outline = **Manuscript §4 — Academic Tenure Setting** (not staging `#12` numbering)

What it means: Before VECTOR can finalize the tenure section with full Cox-backed language, PEER runs Cell 12 and archives hazard-ratio tables.

Soft gate (Charles locked): Cell 9 binned plot (`stage9_inverted_u.png`) is **legitimate for drafting** Setting 3 prose now, labeled **preliminary**. Cell 12 is **before submission**, not before first draft. Arrow = polish/submission, not “cannot write §4 yet.”

Chain 2: Army estimand language → Manuscript methods prose

Shorthand: `CODA estimand sentences ──▶ VECTOR Methods`

Term	Meaning
CODA	Army agent
Estimand sentences	3–5 draft sentences: what Army **Cell 11** measures vs **Cell 12**. Cell 11 = descriptive binned CIF bar panels (within-bin empirical summaries). Cell 12 = inferential cause-specific Cox (hazard-scale curvature). Related but **not** the same object — Cell 11 bars are **not** Cox-predicted curves
VECTOR Methods	Methods/results wording in the manuscript (mostly Army language in **Manuscript §1**; Dakota spine has no separate Methods chapter)

What it means: VECTOR should not invent Army estimand language. Source: `20260611_1633_CODA_to_COMPASS.md` question 3 — still needs **Alex sign-off** before final.

Guards against: Calling Cell 11 bars "Cox-predicted" or claiming causal effects. Enforces "associated with / consistent with" language.

Chain 3: Model-to-data table → Generative modeling section

Shorthand: `SCOUT axis table ──▶ VECTOR Generative §`

Term	Meaning
SCOUT	Basketball/generative agent
Axis table	`axis_table_generative_readouts.md` in D10 bundle — row-by-row map: model quantity → empirical column (`poolq_loo`, `crowding_smooth`, …) → generative plot axis (often whole-roster **pool mean**, not LOO quality) → allowed v1 claim. This is the **explicit axis table** Part III cites
VECTOR Generative §	**Manuscript §5 — Minimal Generative Modeling** (and partly §6 — Mechanism Decomposition)

What it means: VECTOR cannot write the generative section honestly until SCOUT freezes that table — especially the **axis mismatch** limitation (generative POC on pool mean vs empirical inverted-U on `poolq_loo`). Without it, prose over-claims.

Chain 4: Claim status labels → Every manuscript section

Shorthand: `Claim language table ──▶ All sections`

Term	Meaning
Claim language table	`07_Claim_language_guardrails.md` — each major claim tagged **Supported**, **Preliminary**, **Unsupported**, **Defer**, or **Out of scope**
All sections	Every Word manuscript part (empirical triad, theory, generative, predictions, limitations)

What it means: Guardrail layer on top of the science. VECTOR (and Charles) paste prose section by section; each claim must match its status label so "supported" does not slip in where the stack says "preliminary" or "unsupported."

Chain 5: Early Charles decisions → Sequence locked; later CODA questions active

Shorthand: `Charles locked Q1–3 ──▶ Sequence lock (CODA Q4+ open)`

About COMPASS's question file to CODA (`20260611_1626_COMPASS_to_CODA_questions.md`) — **not** the three "Charles clarifications" rows at the top of this doc (deadline, Cox gate, Path II).

Charles locked Q1–3 (2026-06-11):

Q	Decision
Q1 (canonical Army figures)	**Paused** — wait for AWS sync; Charles names canonical cell/run/filenames; CODA does not guess
Q2 (TB-stratified panels)	**Deferred to Alex** — main text, supplement, or defer
Q3 (estimand language)	CODA drafts sentences for Charles + Alex review; not final until Alex signs off

Sequence lock: Those three decisions fix the agent sequence — we know what we are *not* waiting on (CODA guessing figures, CODA choosing TB-stratify placement) and what we *are* (AWS sync, Alex on TB-stratify and estimand wording).

CODA Q4+ open: Questions 4 onward were not paused or deferred to Alex the same way — CODA answered them in the same response: pool harmonization glossary (Q4), pool-size audit timing (Q5 — draft now, audit pre-publication), near-term priority (Q6), AWS workflow (Q8–9), cross-domain harmonization (Q10–11), canonical Army doc list (Q12).

What it means: Plan shape is locked by Q1–Q3; remaining CODA work is the "open" bucket (harmonization, doc pointers, workflow status), not re-litigating figure canon or TB-stratify placement.

Part VII — Shortest defensible path (answer to COMPASS_Initial_Guidance_v6.md final question)

> *Complete minimal model → robust predictions → publishable manuscript*

Path:

1. **Accept** Tier 1 equation + soft assignment as minimal model **without** waiting for L_Q generative identity.
2. **Run** tenure Cell 12 Cox before submission (soft gate — **not urgent during draft**; Charles confirmed CELL 9 sufficient for Setting 3 draft with limitations).
3. **Draft** manuscript immediately after Week 2 exports — empirical triad is already the strongest contribution.
4. **Add** two predictions with one new figure (heterogeneity or dispersion).
5. **Submit** interdisciplinary science-of-science target (venue TBD via `Publication_Plan.md`); network extensions = discussion future work.

Opportunity cost rule: Any task not improving (1)–(5) defers.

Part VIII — COMPASS next actions

1. Continue Charles clarification thread (CODA parallel track, OpenAlex policy, etc.).
2. Incorporate agent answers from `*_to_COMPASS.md` files in `3-Master_Plan/`.
3. Charles routes SCOUT coherence questions; VECTOR drafts after Week 2 exports.
4. Phase 2 artifacts (`DECISION_LOG.md`, `OPEN_QUESTIONS.md`) when Charles requests.
5. Do **not** direct implementation agents to code without Charles routing.
6. External docs: Charles approves markdown; Charles runs PDF conversion (`AGENTS.md`).

End PROJECT_STATUS_AND_NEAR_TERM_PLAN.md